

ing also. He is equally in accord when he promises the righteous a spiritual Paradise, endless in duration, vocal with songs of praise, and bright with the Presence of God and the Spirits that surround the Throne. Even the imagery of celestial food is common to both systems, while the difference between "spring butter" and "the fruit of the vine" is sufficient to prove the emblems wholly independent. We have seen that Zarathushtra associated Judgement with the old mythological idea of the Bridge over which the soul must pass to heaven, but added to it the significant figure of *Cinvant*, "the Separater": here we are at once reminded of Matt. 25³² (and Joel 3¹⁴?). There was one contingency for which Zarathushtra made provision, the thought of which never came into Old or New Testament. His criterion for the "separation" at the Bridge must have been the ancient balancing of merits and offences, the soul going to heaven or hell according as the one or the other predominated. It was inevitable therefore that the case of equal or nearly equal balance should come into consideration. The Christian system went deeper. Every man must be either wheat or tare, either fig or thistle, and a mixed crop of figs and thistledown is unthinkable. Now of course this seems flatly to contradict the facts of life. We are mixed, very mixed; and Zarathushtra undeniably faced a notorious reality, whatever we may think of his solution of it. The Christian answer would be that diagnosis is so impossible to human faculties that we cannot even imagine an absolutely just award upon any one human record: if we are theists we must assume that an infinitely higher Intelligence